

# Student Guide — primary / module-13- indic-ecology

IKS Curriculum

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## Student Workbook

### Student Workbook — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

This workbook is yours to write in. Use it for vocab, exercises, and reflection across all 10 days.

### Vocabulary tracker

Fill in as we go:

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* — \_\_\_\_\_
- *yajña* — \_\_\_\_\_
- *ahiṃsā* — \_\_\_\_\_
- *devarakāḍu* — \_\_\_\_\_
- *sthāvara-jaṅgama* — \_\_\_\_\_

### Day-by-day notes

#### Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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#### Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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### Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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### Day 4 — Sacred Groves

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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### Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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### Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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## Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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## Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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## Day 9 — From Ancient to Action

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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## Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment

**What I learned:**

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**One question I have:**

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## Final reflection

After Day 10, write a paragraph: what is the most important thing you learned in this module?

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## Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

### Goal

Identify the source verse and explain the principle.

### Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

### The flow

#### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

#### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *"What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"*

#### Today's idea (10 min)

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* (IAST: Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam; lit. "the world is one family" — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71")
- Today's BIG idea: *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* — "The whole world is one family."

Show a globe. *"All of us — and all animals, all plants, all rivers — are part of ONE big family."*

Children make a "family tree" with themselves at the centre, then add: parents, siblings, neighbours, then a pet, a tree, a river. Each gets a small drawing.

#### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

#### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

### Homework

(See homework.md.)

## Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

## Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

### Goal

Link Module 2 pañcabhūta to ecology — interconnection.

### Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

### The flow

#### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

#### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

#### Today's idea (10 min)

- *yajña* (IAST: yajña; lit. “cycle of giving and receiving (BG 3.10–14)”)
- The 5 elements are all FAMILY too!
- Earth, water, fire, air, space — they need each other.
- If we pollute water, earth gets hurt. If we cut trees, air gets hurt.

Children draw a circle of friends: 🌍 💧 🔥 🌬️ 🌌 (sun = fire, etc.). Connect them with lines. “*All friends, all family!*”

#### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

#### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

## Homework

(See homework.md.)

## Teacher notes

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## Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

### Goal

Discuss the ecological function of river-worship traditions.

### Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

### The flow

#### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

#### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

#### Today’s idea (10 min)

- *ahiṃsā* (IAST: ahiṃsā; lit. “non-violence; extended to non-human life”)
- Rivers are sacred in India! The Gaṅgā, Yamunā, Sarasvatī...
- Why? Because rivers give us water, food, life!

Show a picture of the Ganga. “*People say: don’t pollute the river. The river is our mother.*”

Children draw a river with fish, plants, and a small flower-offering. Discuss: “*What happens if rivers get dirty?*”

#### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

## Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

## Homework

(See homework.md.)

## Teacher notes

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# Day 4 — Sacred Groves

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

## Goal

Identify devarakāḍu and similar groves as biodiversity reserves.

## Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

## The flow

### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

### Today’s idea (10 min)

- *devarakāḍu* (IAST: devarakāḍu; lit. “sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)”)
- Sacred groves are special little forests that people DON’T cut.
- Why? Because they believe a god, a sage, or an ancestor lives there.
- Animals and plants live safely in these groves.

Show a picture of a grove. “*This is a place where no one breaks a branch.*”

Children draw a tiny forest with animals: birds, butterflies, deer. Add a small temple or shrine.

## Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

## Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

## Homework

(See homework.md.)

## Teacher notes

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# Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

## Goal

Read BG 3.10–14; map yajña to natural-cycle reciprocity.

## Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

## The flow

### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?”

### Today’s idea (10 min)

- *sthāvara-jaṅgama* (IAST: sthāvara-jaṅgama; lit. “immobile (plants, rocks) and mobile (animals) life”)
- *Yajña* (say “yug-nyah”) means giving back — a circle of taking and giving.

Show the cycle: - 🌧️ Rain feeds 🌱 plants - 🌱 Plants feed 🐾 animals (and us!) - 🐾 Animals + us give back to soil - Soil grows more plants

*“If we take but don’t give back, the circle breaks!”*

Children draw the circle with arrows.

### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

### Homework

(See homework.md.)

### Teacher notes

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## Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

### Goal

Read the Earth-mother hymn and discuss imagery.

### Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

### The flow

#### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

#### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: *“What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?”*

#### Today’s idea (10 min)

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* (IAST: Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam; lit. “the world is one family” — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71)

- An old, old song says: “*The Earth is my Mother!*”

Show the words on the board: “*mātā bhūmiḥ putro ahaṁ pṛthivyāḥ*”

“*Long ago, people sang to the Earth like she was a mother. They asked: please give us food. And they said: I will care for you.*”

Children draw the Earth with a smiling face. Around the edge, they draw what the Earth gives us (trees, water, food). Inside their drawing, they write one promise: “I will \_\_\_\_\_.”

### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

### Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

### Teacher notes

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- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

## Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

### Goal

Translate *īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ* and discuss its ecological implication.

### Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

### The flow

#### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

#### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

### Today's idea (10 min)

- *yajña* (IAST: yajña; lit. “cycle of giving and receiving (BG 3.10–14)”)
- An old wise verse says: “*Take only what you need!*”

The verse: “*īśāvāsyam idaṁ sarvaṁ...*” — “All this is one big home.”

“*If you take TOO much, others don't have enough. If you waste, the Earth gets sad.*”

Children think of one thing they sometimes take too much of (food, water, time on screens). They draw it with a small heart, promising: “*I'll take just what I need.*”

### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

### Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

### Teacher notes

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- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

## Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

### Goal

Summarise key IPCC findings; what is changing and why.

### Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

### The flow

#### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

### Today's idea (10 min)

- *ahimsā* (IAST: *ahimsā*; lit. “non-violence; extended to non-human life”)
- The Earth is getting warmer because we burn too much fuel.
- Ice is melting. Some animals lose their homes. Some farms have trouble.

Show simple graphics: a thermometer going up, an ice cube melting, a tree being planted.

“*What can WE do?*” Children brainstorm: walk instead of drive, plant trees, save water, don't waste food. Pick one to try this week.

### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

### Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

### Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

## Day 9 — From Ancient to Action

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

### Goal

Design one local environmental project applying an Indic-ecology principle.

### Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

## The flow

### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “What's one thing you remember from yesterday?”

### Today's idea (10 min)

- *devarakāḍu* (IAST: devarakāḍu; lit. “sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)”)
- Time to PICK a project!
- Some ideas:
  1. **Plant trees** in our school garden
  2. **Save water** — turn off the tap when brushing
  3. **Sort waste** — separate paper, plastic, food
  4. **Make a poster** about saving Earth

Each child picks one project. Draws what they'll do. Names one Indian principle (Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam, Yajña, take-only-what-you-need).

### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

## Homework

(See homework.md.)

## Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

## Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment

**Module:** Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

## Goal

Present project pitches; summative quiz.

## Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

## The flow

### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

### Today's idea (10 min)

- *sthāvara-jāṅgama* (IAST: sthāvara-jāṅgama; lit. “immobile (plants, rocks) and mobile (animals) life”)
- Project share day! Each child shows their drawing and tells the class their plan.

Cheer for each one. “*Every project counts!*”

Quiz with stickers — everyone gets an “Earth Friend” sticker.

End: hold hands in a big circle. Say together: “*Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam — one big family!*”

### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

## Homework

(See homework.md.)

## Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

# Homework

## Homework — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
2. **Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
3. **Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
4. **Day 4 — Sacred Groves** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — From Ancient to Action** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

## Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.